# Oils (omega-3, fish oil, coconut oil): HMTc Standard

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CITE AS

Pendergrass K. "Oils (omega-3, fish oil, coconut oil): HMTc Standard". Heavy Metal Certified, 2026. https://heavymetalcertified.-com/standards/pet-supplements-oils. CC BY 4.0.

CORRESPONDENCE

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KEYWORDS

heavy metals, food safety, dietary exposure

PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08.

## Abstract

The Heavy Metal Tested & Certified heavy-metal-safety standard for oils (omega-3, fish oil, coconut oil) in Pet Supplements, evaluated on the supplement as sold (as-packaged concentrate): dry weight for powders, chews, tablets and capsules, neat liquid for oils and drops; no reconstitution, dilution, or as-fed conversion is applied. 7 of 11 panel analytes publish a numeric limit taken from the strictest applicable government maximum; the remainder are held under mandatory control or a substantiated not-material determination.

## 1 | How every number on this standard is set

HMTc Method v2.0 (government-limit default), pet-supplement double over-compliance form: the exact cell's only sovereign maximum is an animal-feed instrument, which is disclosed as a floor and never used; every published value is a disclosed read-across to the strictest applicable as-sold child-protective human-food sovereign maximum in the product's native as-sold basis, or a control where no as-sold sovereign value exists. Never occurrence-derived.

## 2 | Master limit table

All values in ppb (µg/kg), as sold basis. A brand meeting every value qualifies for the mark.

| ANALYTE | TIER | HMTC LIMIT | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Lead (Pb) | Tier 1 | 10 | human-grade read-across (Israel) |
| Cadmium (Cd) | Tier 1 | 5 | human-grade read-across (Israel) |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Total arsenic (tAs) | Tier 2 | 50 | human-grade read-across (India) |
| Inorganic arsenic (iAs) | Tier 1 | 20 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Mercury, total (tHg) | Tier 1 | 4 | human-grade read-across (Israel) |
| Methylmercury (MeHg) | Tier 1 | ≤ tHg | bounded by tHg (reflex speciation) |
| Nickel (Ni) | Tier 2 | 250 | human-grade read-across (European Union) |
| Tin (Sn) | Tier 2 | 5,000 | human-grade read-across (India) |
| Aluminium (Al) | Tier 2 | 500 | human-grade read-across (Australia / New Zealand) |
| Total chromium (Cr) | Tier 2 | 1,000 | human-grade read-across (China) |
| Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI) | Tier 2 | ≤ Cr | bounded by Cr (reflex speciation) |

## 3 | Derivation — where each number comes from

Every cell traces to one named sovereign maximum level (the strictest for the nearest analog), or to an explicit control, not-material, or species-bounded determination. No occurrence statistic selects a certification value.

| ANALYTE | HMTC | SOVEREIGN ANALOG / DETERMINATION |
|---|---|---|
| Lead (Pb) | 10 | Israel — human-food analog |
| Cadmium (Cd) | 5 | Israel — human-food analog |
| Total arsenic (tAs) | 50 | India — human-food analog |
| Inorganic arsenic (iAs) | 20 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Mercury, total (tHg) | 4 | Israel — human-food analog |
| Methylmercury (MeHg) | ≤ tHg | MeHg carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total tHg (MeHg <= tHg), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell. |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Nickel (Ni) | 250 | European Union — human-food analog |
| Tin (Sn) | 5,000 | India — human-food analog |
| Aluminium (Al) | 500 | Australia / New Zealand — human-food analog |
| Total chromium (Cr) | 1,000 | China — human-food analog |
| Hexavalent chromium (Cr-VI) | ≤ Cr | Cr-VI carries no product-specific sovereign cell; it is a component of and bounded by its parent total Cr (Cr-VI <= Cr), an enforceable ceiling via reflex speciation rather than an empty cell. |

## 4 | Cite this standard

Pendergrass, K. "Oils (omega-3, fish oil, coconut oil)." In Heavy Metal Tested & Certified (HMTc) Pet Supplements standard, version 1.0 (2026-08-17). Institute of Contaminant Standards (ICS), 2026.

## References


[1] Australia / New Zealand — human-food maximum levels
Binds Al. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[2] China — human-food maximum levels
Binds Cr. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[3] European Union — human-food maximum levels
Binds iAs, Ni. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[4] Israel — human-food maximum levels
Binds Pb, Cd, tHg. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL

[5] India — human-food maximum levels
Binds tAs, Sn. Strictest applicable human-food sovereign maximum for the nearest analog.
MAXIMUM LEVEL



STATUS AND LICENCE

Editorially reviewed in-house; no external peer review has been completed on this reference. Published as a preprint with its review state tracked on the article page. Released under CC BY 4.0.

## COMPETING INTERESTS

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## PUBLICATION HISTORY

This revision 2026-08. The full dated record is maintained at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/-pet-supplements-oils.

## DATA AVAILABILITY

The works this reference draws on are listed in full in the references above and on the briefing page at https://heavymetalcertified.com/standards/pet--supplements-oils. Primary legal instruments and expert-body assessments are named with their public identifiers; the underlying occurrence and toxicology corpus is maintained on the Heavy Metal Index.